# Sash.Ai Forge — Handover & Next Steps

Actionable punch list for DevOps, SEO/AEO, and content. Owner to prioritise.

| Live URL (v1) | Target domain | Repo |
|---|---|---|
| sovitgarg.github.io/sash_ai_forge/ | forge.sashai.tech | github.com/sovitgarg/sash_ai_forge |

**Date**
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## 1 DevOps — host on `forge.sashai.tech` P1 · 30 MIN

1. **Create `CNAME` file** in repo root containing `forge.sashai.tech` (single line, no protocol). Commit & push to `main`.
2. **DNS (at registrar of `sashai.tech`)** — add one record:

   ```
   Type: CNAME   Name: forge   Value: sovitgarg.github.io.   TTL: 300
   ```

   If root-domain redirect is wanted later, use four A records pointing to `185.199.108.153, .109.153, .110.153, .111.153`.
3. **GitHub: Settings → Pages →** enter `forge.sashai.tech` as Custom domain. Wait for DNS check (~5 min). Tick **Enforce HTTPS**.
4. **Rewrite canonical URLs** from `sovitgarg.github.io/sash_ai_forge` → `forge.sashai.tech` in: `index.html` (canonical, OG, Twitter, 6× JSON-LD), `llms.txt`, `sitemap.xml`, `robots.txt`, `404.html`, `assets/js/config.js`. One grep: `grep -rl "sovitgarg.github.io/sash_ai_forge" .`
5. **Submit to Google Search Console** (new property: `forge.sashai.tech`) + Bing Webmaster Tools. Submit sitemap.
6. **Verify**: `curl -I https://forge.sashai.tech/` returns 200 · valid TLS cert · no redirect chain · `Cache-Control` present.

> **Rollback plan:** if DNS goes wrong, remove the CNAME record and the repo's `CNAME` file — site falls back to `sovitgarg.github.io/sash_ai_forge/` automatically, zero downtime.

## 2 SEO quick wins P1 · WEEK 1

- **Search Console**: verify domain, request indexing for `/`, submit `sitemap.xml`.
- **Backlinks from day 1**: add forge URL to sashai.tech nav, founder LinkedIn bios, Y Combinator Startup School directory, Product Hunt profile, ProductHunt "Ship", and 3 India startup directories (IVCA, Inc42, YourStory).
- **Google Business Profile** for "Sash.Ai Forge" at Bengaluru address — gets you into Maps + local pack for "AI startup builder Bengaluru".
- **Replace OG image** with a 1200×630 PNG (current is SVG; some platforms don't render SVG OG). Tools: Figma export, or Canva "Open Graph" template.
- **Wire real LinkedIn / Instagram / X URLs** (currently `#` with TODOs in footer + team cards). Add them to `Organization.sameAs[]` JSON-LD too.

- **Add real team photos** (swap initial monograms). Brief: warm neutral background, even lighting, 1:1 crop, 400×400 WebP + JPEG fallback.
- **45-day plan blog post** — repurpose §6 as a standalone blog post on sashai.tech with a CTA back to forge.sashai.tech.

## 3 AEO (Answer Engine Optimisation) P2 · MONTH 1

- **Claim presence in ChatGPT / Perplexity / Claude** by publishing 3 pillar pages (on `sashai.tech/blog` or forge subpath):
  - "How to launch an AI startup without a technical co-founder"
  - "Idea → MVP in 45 days: the non-tech founder playbook"
  - "Tech co-founder vs fractional CTO vs launchpad — the honest trade-off"

  Each: ≥1,500 words, 1 quote per 500 words, tables + lists, FAQ schema.
- **Refresh `llms.txt` + `llms-full.txt`** whenever pricing, team, or positioning changes. Set a quarterly reminder.
- **Structured-data test**: run current site through validator.schema.org and Google Rich Results Test; fix any warnings.
- **Wikidata entity** for AIxplora Technologies Pvt Ltd — low effort, high AEO leverage (LLMs pull from Wikidata heavily).
- **Authorship**: add `author` schema with LinkedIn sameAs links to every blog post — amplifies Biddappa/Shabareesh E-E-A-T signal.

## 4 Conversion & measurement P2 · WEEK 2

- **Enable Plausible analytics** — uncomment the snippet in `index.html` (bottom, clearly marked) and set `window.SAF_CONFIG.analyticsProvider = "plausible"`. No cookie banner needed.
- **WhatsApp lead tagging works already** — each CTA pre-fills a source tag (`Hero`, `Sticky`, `Journey: Step 2`, etc.). Set up a simple tracker in the Sash ops sheet to count source → conversion.
- **A/B test hero H1** after 2 weeks of baseline traffic: variant "From idea to launched AI startup. In weeks." — speed-led vs completeness-led.
- **Add Google Tag Manager (optional)** only if attribution is needed for paid ads — otherwise Plausible is enough.

## 5 Content still in placeholder state P2

| Item | Current state | Action |
|---|---|---|
| Team photos | Initial monograms (BM/SR/SD) | Replace `.team-card__avatar` divs with `<img>` |
| LinkedIn URLs | `href="#"` × 3 | Replace TODO-commented anchors |
| Social URLs (footer) | `href="#"` × 3 | LinkedIn / IG / X |
| Pricing numbers | "Starts from — let's talk" | Owner call — numbers or keep opaque |

| Item | Current state | Action |
|---|---|---|
| Case studies §8 | Commented-out | Uncomment when Grambvels + Kokken outcomes are shareable |
| OG image | SVG placeholder | Export 1200×630 PNG, replace `og-image.svg` references |

## 6 Ongoing hygiene P3

- Monthly: re-run Lighthouse (target ≥ 95/95/95/100); re-run `pa11y` or axe on any copy/structure change.
- Quarterly: refresh `llms-full.txt`, FAQ schema, and sitemap `lastmod`.
- Any content change: one commit per change, PR optional but encouraged once team grows.
- Brand: if logo wordmark is ever replaced with a graphical mark, update `favicon.svg`, `og-image.svg`, and `Organization.logo` JSON-LD in one commit.

## 7 Phase-2 backlog (out of scope for v1) P3

- Blog at `/blog` — 3 pillar + 6 answer posts (see §2 above).
- Lead magnet PDF: "The Non-Tech Founder's 8-Week MVP Playbook" → form-gated via ConvertKit or Mailchimp.
- Testimonials carousel — once 3+ founders agree on record.
- 60-second founder hero video (Biddappa or Shabareesh, direct to camera).
- Upgrade mailto form to Formspree / Getform — keeps UX identical but captures leads even if the user's mail client is misconfigured.